

HOUSE JOINT RESOLUTION 751

By Atchley

A RESOLUTION recognizing the City of Gatlinburg as the official Gateway to the Smokies.

WHEREAS, Gatlinburg borders the Great Smoky Mountains National Park, with multiple park entrances, including the primary Sugarlands entrance, located within or immediately adjacent to the city, providing the most direct and most popular access point for visitors; and

WHEREAS, Gatlinburg is widely recognized as the gateway community to the Great Smoky Mountains National Park, the most visited national park in the United States, attracting over 13 million visitors annually in recent years, many of whom enter through Gatlinburg; and

WHEREAS, the city serves as a primary basecamp for park exploration, surrounded on three sides by the mountains and offering immediate access to key trails, visitor centers, and scenic routes that lead into the heart of the Smokies; and

WHEREAS, Gatlinburg's location along U.S. Route 441 positions it as the busiest and most tourist-oriented entryway to the park, facilitating the majority of visitor traffic from the Tennessee side and supporting the park's role as a premier destination for millions each year; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE SENATE CONCURRING, that we hereby designate the City of Gatlinburg as the official Gateway to the Smokies.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.